

MODE: SKETCH

One key, a hand-drawn deck.

Set the *mode* once in front matter and every slide inherits the rendering mode. A **finish** backdrop can layer on top — they're separate axes now.

Mode is the rendering hand — separate from the backdrop.

`mode:` names the whole-deck *hand* in a single token — how the content itself is drawn. It's orthogonal to `theme:` (the palette) and to `finish:` (the backdrop painted behind). The engine reads it once and appends the mapped classes to every slide, so you never repeat `sketch` per slide.

Boardroom

The clean baseline — omit the key and you get it.

Sketch

Felt-tip headings, a hand-sans for prose, drawn boxes.

Sketch-clean

Hand headings and boxes, but a clean body for dense slides.

It composes with per-slide layouts.

A per-slide `_class:` is appended to, not overwritten by, the deck-wide mode — so `cards-grid` here renders as a hand-drawn grid with no extra markup.

Append, not replace

`mode: sketch` + `_class: cards-grid` becomes
`cards-grid sketch`.

Palette-blind

The mode wobbles type and geometry; the theme still colors it.

Two render paths

The owned engine and the live preview both read the same key.

Mode and finish are two axes – layer a backdrop on the hand.

Because they're separate registers, a deck can wear both: the sketch *hand* over an atrium *backdrop*, with no magic and no fighting for one key. Add a per-slide `_class: boardroom` to make one slide clean while the deck stays hand-drawn.

One deck, both axes

`mode: sketch` + `finish: atrium` = a hand-drawn deck on a gridded glow.

Opt out per slide

`_class: boardroom` renders that one slide clean, backdrop intact.

No magic

The mode and the backdrop each have their own readable key.

How the deck is wired.

01 Front matter declares

mode: sketch

once

→ **Every slide inherits the hand mode**

auto

03 A

finish: backdrop layers on top

separate axis

04 Per-slide layouts compose too

cards-grid

05 The linter guards both keys against typos

unknown-mode

A typo can't ship silently.

An unrecognized value resolves to no classes, so a misspelling like `mode: sketchh` would quietly render the boardroom baseline. The deck linter catches it first — the same guard covers `finish:`.

The guard

`npm run lint:deck` flags it as an `unknown-mode` warning.

The fix

Use one of `boardroom`, `sketch`, or `sketch-clean`.

The principle

No magic default — the baseline has a name you can read.

ONE LINE TO RE-HAND THE ROOM

*Change the mode, keep the
content.*

Flip `mode:` to `boardroom` and the same Markdown ships as a clean deck — no edits to a single slide, and any `finish:` backdrop rides along untouched.